3. To prevent tooth decay, reduce the intake of carbohydrates, especially sweet snacks between meals.
4. Brushing of the teeth at least four times a day is a basic to an effective oral hygiene (after meals and at bed time)
5. Tooth brushes should be replaced every three months.
6. After brushing, thorough rinsing is important to remove dislodged food particles.

Risk Factors for Oral Problems

1. Patients who are paralyzed or seriously ill.
2. Unconscious patients.
3. Diabetic patients.
4. Patients undergoing radiation therapy.
5. Patients receiving Chemotherapy
6. Patients having oral surgery, trauma.
7. Patients with immune suppression drug e.g HIV Patients.

Common Oral Problems

The two major types of oral problems are dental caries (cavities) and periodontal disease ({Pyorrhea)

1. Dental caries is the most common oral problem of younger people. The development of the cavity involves the destruction of tooth enamel through decalcification. Decalcification is a result of an accumulation of mucin, carbohydrates and lactic acid bacilli in the saliva normally found in the mouth, which forms a coating on the teeth called Plaque. Plaque is transparent and adheres to the teeth near the base of the crown at the gum margins. The plaque prevents normal acid dilution and neutralization, preventing the dissolution of bacteria in the oral cavity. The acid eventually destroys the teeth enamel and in severe cases, the pulp, or inner sponge tissue of the teeth.
2. Periodontal disease is the disease of the tissue around the tooth. It is an inflammation of the periodontal membrane. It is most common problem of people over 35 years of age. The calculus deposit on teeth at the gum line. The gingivae become swollen and tender. Then the inflammation spreads, pockets develop between gums gingivae. The alveolar bone is destroyed and the teeth loosen.
3. Halitosis (Bad Breath):- is a common problem of the oral cavity.

   Causes: i. Poor oral hygiene
   ii. Inspection of the oral cavity
   iii. Liver disease
   iv. Diabetes
4. Cheilosis is the disorder involves cracking of the lips especially at the ankle of the mouth.

   Causes: i. Riboflavin deficiency
   ii. Mouth breathing
   iii. Excess salivation.
5. Stomatitis is an inflammative condition of the mouth.

   Causes: i. Contact with irritants such tobacco

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